

Araby

James Joyce · 1914

First published: Dubliners, 1914

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Dubliners/Araby (revision 6617246), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Araby suggest about romantic idealism and disillusionment?
- What does Araby suggest about coming of age?
- What does Araby suggest about religion and desire?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Araby	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*romantic idealism and disillusionment* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Araby

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about James Joyce's life or times connects to romantic idealism and disillusionment in “Araby”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (romantic idealism and disillusionment, coming of age, religion and desire).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

James Joyce was born in Dublin on 2 February 1882 and educated by Jesuits. He left Ireland in 1904 with Nora Barnacle and lived in Trieste, Zurich and Paris, but wrote almost entirely about Dublin. Dubliners (1914), a collection of fifteen stories, was delayed for years by publishers' fears of libel and obscenity; it was followed by A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man (1916), Ulysses (1922) and Finnegans Wake (1939). He died in Zurich on 13 January 1941.

Historical and cultural context

Dublin around 1895 was a city under British rule, shaped by the Catholic Church and economic stagnation. Araby was a real bazaar held in Dublin in May 1894.

Publication and reception, then and now

Published in Dubliners (1914), a collection Joyce completed by 1907 that publishers rejected for years.

Then: Dubliners sold poorly.

Now: A landmark of modernist short fiction and the "epiphany."

Overview (spoiler-free)

A boy on North Richmond Street is infatuated with his friend's older sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift.

Main themes

- disillusionment.
- romantic idealism.
- paralysis.

Why it matters

Students recognize the experience of a crush and the moment idealism breaks.

Spoilers · teacher only

His uncle comes home late; the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes and finds it shabby; he realizes his romantic dream was vanity.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open Araby: Describe a time something you looked forward to turned out disappointing.
Prompt: Before we open Araby: Describe a time something you looked forward to turned out disappointing.

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
epiphany; first-person retrospective narration; imagery; symbolism.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. James Joyce was born in Dublin on 2 February 1882 and educated by Jesuits. He left Ireland in 1904 with Nora Barnacle and lived in Trieste, Zurich and Paris, but wrote almost entirely about Dublin. Dubliners (1914), a collection of fifteen stories, was delayed for years by publishers' fears of libel and obscenity; it was followed by A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man (1916), Ulysses (1922) and Finnegans Wake (1939). He died in Zurich on 13 January 1941. The world of the book. Dublin around 1895 was a city under British rule, shaped by the Catholic Church and economic stagnation. Araby was a real bazaar held in Dublin in May 1894. Publication and reception. Published in Dubliners (1914), a collection Joyce completed by 1907 that publishers rejected for years. Then: Dubliners sold poorly. Now: A landmark of modernist short fiction and the "epiphany."

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street" slowly and put it in my own words: North Richmond Street is a quiet, dead-end street. Next, craft. I notice "blind," used for a street, which means it has no way out. The strongest word is "blind": it suggests a place without vision or escape, which matches the boy's life. Then, effect. How does this first sentence set up the boy's world? My answer: Joyce opens in a closed-in Dublin street; the boy will try to escape through his dream of Araby and fail.

> *North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street (Araby, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street" slowly and put it in my own words: North Richmond Street is a quiet, dead-end street. Next, craft. I notice "blind," used for a street, which means it has no way out. The strongest word is "blind": it suggests a place without vision or escape, which matches the boy's life. Then, effect. How does this first sentence set up the boy's world? My answer: Joyce opens in a closed-in Dublin street; the boy will try to escape through his dream of Araby and fail.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): A boy on North Richmond Street is infatuated with his friend's older sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. Themes to track: disillusionment.: romantic idealism.: paralysis.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: romantic idealism. Prediction: the boy's crush on Mangan's sister will turn his trip to the Araby bazaar into a kind of quest. Question: will the real bazaar match the one he imagines?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Araby: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: romantic idealism. Prediction: the boy's crush on Mangan's sister will turn his trip to the Araby bazaar into a kind of quest. Question: will the real bazaar match the one he imagines?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Araby still matter? Students recognize the experience of a crush and the moment idealism breaks.
Anchor question: Why might Araby still be taught today?
Facilitation: Students recognize the experience of a crush and the moment idealism breaks.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Joyce grew up in Dublin and wrote Dubliners while living abroad. Why might he write about Dublin as a place where people feel stuck? Answer: Accept answers such as: he felt Ireland was "paralyzed" by church, poverty and politics; he left Dublin himself; he wanted to show ordinary lives honestly.
Exit ticket: Joyce grew up in Dublin and wrote Dubliners while living abroad. Why might he write about Dublin as a place where people feel stuck?
Answer: Accept answers such as: he felt Ireland was "paralyzed" by church, poverty and politics; he left Dublin himself; he wanted to show ordinary lives honestly.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Araby.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "James Joyce" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/James-Joyce); James Joyce Centre, Dublin (https://jamesjoyce.ie/); James Joyce Centre, Dublin (https://jamesjoyce.ie/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Araby bazaar date (May 1894) is from Joyce scholarship.

Lesson 2: Araby

Focus: a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Araby” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…We walked through the flaring streets, jostled by drunken men and bargaining women, amid the curs…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: “What does this detail add to the scene?”

Teacher only · spoilers

A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature driven and derided by vanity.'

Background: Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life.

Significance: A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to disillusionment because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to disillusionment because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: his quest collapses.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: impinge — to press against or strike upon; converged — came together from different directions; derided — mocked or ridiculed; garrulous — talking too much, especially about unimportant things; pitilessly — without pity or mercy. "impinge": Origin: Latin impingō ("dash against"). "converged": Origin of "converge": Latin convergere.
Words: impinge: to press against or strike upon · converged: came together from different directions · derided: mocked or ridiculed · garrulous: talking too much, especially about unimportant things · pitilessly: without pity or mercy

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life. A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1. Epiphany: The final sentence is a sudden self-recognition. Imagery: Light and darkness; religious imagery ("chalice"). Point of view: An older narrator looks back on his younger self. Watch for the bazaar: the exotic dream that turns ordinary.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" slowly and put it in my own words: Running errands with his aunt, the boy pictures himself carrying a sacred cup safely through enemies. Next, craft. I notice the religious and knightly image, a chalice and foes, laid over an ordinary shopping trip. The strongest word is "chalice": a chalice holds communion wine, so his crush becomes holy in his mind. Then, effect. What does the boy imagine as he walks through the market? My answer: As he carries his aunt's parcels through the flaring streets on Saturday evenings, the boy imagines he is carrying a holy chalice through enemies, turning his feelings into a romantic quest; the bigger the fantasy, the harder his fall at the end.

> *I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes* (Araby, paragraph 5)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" slowly and put it in my own words: Running errands with his aunt, the boy pictures himself carrying a sacred cup safely through enemies. Next, craft. I notice the religious and knightly image, a chalice and foes, laid over an ordinary shopping trip. The strongest word is "chalice": a chalice holds communion wine, so his crush becomes holy in his mind. Then, effect. What does the boy imagine as he walks through the market? My answer: As he carries his aunt's parcels through the flaring streets on Saturday evenings, the boy imagines he is carrying a holy chalice through enemies, turning his feelings into a romantic quest; the bigger the fantasy, the harder his fall at the end.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The chalice turns errands into a holy quest, showing how he idealizes his love. Ask: How does this line connect to disillusionment? Expected: His quest collapses. (Epiphany.)

> *Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity* (Araby, paragraph 37)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The chalice turns errands into a holy quest, showing how he idealizes his love.
Ask: How does this line connect to disillusionment?
Expected answer: His quest collapses. (Epiphany.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for epiphany, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. When the text says “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5), it shows this directly. He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity."
Task: Annotate the story for epiphany, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. When the text says “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5), it shows this directly. He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why? Ask: is the ending tragic or a step toward growing up?
Anchor question: Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?
Facilitation: Ask: is the ending tragic or a step toward growing up?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. ("I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes", Araby, paragraph 5). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. ("I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes", Araby, paragraph 5). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how epiphany shapes a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Key takeaway: his quest collapses.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Epiphany:** The final sentence is a sudden self-recognition.
- **Imagery:** Light and darkness; religious imagery ("chalice").
- **Point of view:** An older narrator looks back on his younger self.

Themes and how they develop

- **disillusionment:** his quest collapses.

Symbols and motifs

- **the bazaar:** the exotic dream that turns ordinary.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5) Romantic quest.
- "Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity" (Araby, paragraph 37) Epiphany.
- "North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street" (Araby, paragraph 1) Paralysis.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion.
Evidence: "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5)

Reasoning: He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
impinge (verb)	to press against or strike upon	*Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.*	"impinge": Origin: Latin impingō ("dash against"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/impinge#Etymology)
converged (verb)	came together from different directions	*These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.*	"converged": Origin of "converge": Latin convergere. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/converge#Etymology)
derided (verb)	mocked or ridiculed	*Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.*	
garrulous (adjective)	talking too much, especially about unimportant things	*She was an old garrulous woman, a pawnbroker's widow, who collected used stamps for some pious purpose.*	
pitilessly (adverb)	without pity or mercy	*The air was pitilessly raw and already my heart misgave me.*	
annihilate (verb)	to destroy completely	*I wished to annihilate the tedious intervening days.*	"annihilate": Origin: Latin annihilātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/annihilate#Etymology)
liberated (verb)	set free	*The high cold empty gloomy rooms liberated me and I went from room to room singing.*	
parcels (noun)	packages	*On Saturday evenings when my aunt went marketing I had to go to carry some of the parcels.*	
sixpence (noun)	a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970	*I allowed the two pennies to fall against the sixpence in my pocket.*	"sixpence": Origin: an English formation from six + pence. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/sixpence#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?
2. Where does imagery appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with romantic idealism and disillusionment?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does the boy live? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: North Richmond Street, Dublin
2. Whom does the boy admire? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mangan's sister
3. Why does he go to Araby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To buy her a gift
4. Why does he arrive late? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His uncle comes home late
5. What does the boy feel at the end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Anguish and anger at his own vanity
6. Retell the three most important events of "Araby" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature driven and derided by vanity.'
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Araby"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Araby" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds." What does "impinge" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: impinge: to press against or strike upon.
10. Reread: "These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes." What does "converged" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: converged: came together from different directions.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Araby” suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.
2. Find one example of imagery in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
3. How does the point of view in this story shape what we understand about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. On point of view: An older narrator looks back on his younger self. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died.”, why might Joyce have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Araby”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature…
6. As the opening story, what does “Araby” set up that the rest of Araby will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with romantic idealism and disillusionment? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own

illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Araby” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. On point of view: An older narrator looks back on his younger self. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Araby”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to coming of age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Joyce need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the imagery in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. On imagery: Light and darkness; religious imagery ("chalice"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Araby” treats a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Araby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve romantic idealism and disillusionment? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask James Joyce about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "On Saturday evenings when my aunt went marketing I had to go to carry some of the _____." Word bank: parcels, converged, derided, impinge
   Key: parcels
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The high cold empty gloomy rooms _____ me and I went from room to room singing." Word bank: impinge, derided, converged, liberated
   Key: liberated
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Araby, paragraph 37: "Gazing up into the _____ I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity"
   Key: darkness
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Where does the boy live?
   A. Cork
   B. Belfast
   C. London
   D. North Richmond Street, Dublin
   Key: D (North Richmond Street, Dublin)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 3: "Or if Mangan's sister came out on the _____ to call her brother in to his tea we watched her from our shadow peer up and down the street."
   Word bank: doorstep, returned, waiting, because
   Key: doorstep
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Araby, paragraph 1: "North _____ Street, being blind, was a quiet street"
   Key: Richmond
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Araby, paragraph 5: "I _____ that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes"
   Key: imagined
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Whom does the boy admire?
   A. Mangan's sister
   B. His aunt
   C. A shop girl
   D. A nun
   Key: A (Mangan's sister)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] What does the boy feel at the end?

   A. Relief

   B. Joy

   C. Anguish and anger at his own vanity

   D. Love

   Key: C (Anguish and anger at his own vanity)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.4] What does this passage from paragraph 4 reveal about the character or situation? “I kept her brown figure always in my eye and, when we came near the point at which our ways diverged, I quickened my pace and passed her.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 4) accurately and quotes “quickened” and “diverged”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.4] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “I liked the last best because its leaves were yellow.”

    B. “Among these I found a few paper-covered books, the pages of which were curled and damp: The Abbot, by Walter Scott, The Devout Communicant…”

    C. “The former tenant of our house, a priest, had died in the back drawing-room.”

    D. “Air, musty from having been long enclosed, hung in all the rooms, and the waste room behind the kitchen was littered with old useless…”

    Key: C (“The former tenant of our house, a priest, had died in the back drawing-room.”)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.4] Which choice best states a central concern of “Araby”?

    A. A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

    B. Reason defeating a hidden crime

    C. The art of the deadpan tall tale

    D. Confinement driving a woman into madness

    Key: A (A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.4] What does this passage from paragraph 24 reveal about the character or situation? “In a few minutes the train drew up beside an improvised wooden platform.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 24) accurately and quotes “improvised” and “platform”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 25 shapes its tone: “I recognised a silence like that which pervades a church after a service.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 25) accurately and quotes “recognised” and “pervades”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Paralysis. The words “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops disillusionment: his quest collapses.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Connect this passage from paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “When he was midway through his dinner I asked him to give me the money to go to the bazaar.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 19) accurately and quotes “through” and “midway”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to coming of age and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The air was _____ raw and already my heart misgave me.” Word bank: derided, impinge, converged, pitilessly
    Key: pitilessly
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Why does he go to Araby?
    A. To meet friends
    B. To buy her a gift
    C. To see his uncle
    D. To work

    Key: B (To buy her a gift)
19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.4] What can you infer from this line? “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Epiphany. The words “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself.
20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.4] What can you infer from this line? “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Romantic quest. The words “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself.
21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Araby”? Light and darkness; religious this device ("chalice").
    A. Conflict
    B. Plot
    C. Imagery
    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: C (Imagery)
22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Araby”? The final sentence is a sudden self-recognition.
    A. Epiphany
    B. Plot
    C. Simile
    D. Tone / mood

    Key: A (Epiphany)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive only in part. In support, “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5) bears it out: He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity.". But “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1) complicates it, because this detail (paralysis) gives the reader a second explanation to weigh against the claim's reading. So the claim holds only once it is qualified: it explains much of the story, but it has to account for that passage too, which it does not do on its own.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I wished to _____ the tedious intervening days.” Word bank: annihilate, impinge, derided, converged

    Key: annihilate

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 3? “When the short days of winter came dusk fell before we had well eaten our _____.”

    A. dinners

    B. waiting

    C. summons

    D. doorstep

    Key: A (dinners)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “I liked the last best because its leaves were yellow.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 2) accurately and quotes “because” and “leaves”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Connect this passage from paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “Her brother always teased her before he obeyed and I stood by the railings looking at her.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 3) accurately and quotes “railings” and “brother”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to coming of age and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 7: “It would be a _____ bazaar, she said she would love to go.” Word bank: towards, pulled, splendid, followed

    Key: splendid

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 9 shapes its tone: “While she spoke she turned a silver bracelet round and round her wrist.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 9) accurately and quotes “bracelet” and “turned”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Claim: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5).

    Sample answer: He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity.". The words “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops disillusionment: his quest collapses.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Connect this passage from paragraph 24 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “I held a florin tightly in my hand as I strode down Buckingham Street towards the station.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 24) accurately and quotes “Buckingham” and “station”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to coming of age and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Why does he arrive late?

    A. He gets lost

    B. His uncle comes home late

    C. He oversleeps

    D. The train breaks

    Key: B (His uncle comes home late)

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “"If I go," I said, "I will bring you something."” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 11) accurately and quotes “something”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Synthesis: trace how disillusionment develops from the opening of “Araby” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    Sample answer: His quest collapses: romantic quest. The words “Araby” (Araby, paragraph 5) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops disillusionment: his quest collapses. He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity.".

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Connect this passage from paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “The cold air stung us and we played till our bodies glowed.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 3) accurately and quotes “bodies” and “played”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to coming of age and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of coming of age: his quest collapses.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Romantic quest. The words “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops disillusionment: his quest collapses. He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity.".

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity" (Araby, paragraph 37) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Epiphany. The words "Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity" (Araby, paragraph 37) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops disillusionment: his quest collapses. He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 1, 7, 2, 17, 18, 3, 8, 4, 19, 12, 20, 15, 21, 22, 23	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	24, 2, 9, 25, 8, 5, 10, 12, 11, 19, 13, 21, 26, 14, 16, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 24, 8, 5, 28, 10, 19, 13, 11, 12, 26, 15, 29, 30, 23, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 32, 4, 1, 19, 12, 10, 13, 11, 29, 22, 15, 33, 23, 34, 31	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 24, 25, 10, 12, 11, 19, 14, 15, 22, 21, 30, 23, 31, 16, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	28, 25, 5, 10, 11, 12, 13, 21, 26, 29, 14, 22, 16, 35, 23, 36	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 3, 11, 10, 19, 12, 15, 29, 22, 26, 21, 23, 34, 31, 35, 36	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 17, 12, 10, 11, 21, 15, 22, 14, 33, 27, 34, 23, 16, 31, 36	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	24, 17, 4, 8, 11, 22, 29, 26, 14, 27, 16, 35, 34, 23, 31, 37	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	6, 17, 4, 12, 21, 26, 29, 33, 22, 14, 35, 31, 34, 23, 16, 27	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Araby," how does Joyce show a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Araby, how does Joyce develop the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Araby (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Araby suggests about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's imagery and point of view), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how James Joyce uses imagery in Araby to complicate the reader's understanding of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Araby within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Araby alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Araby and its treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's imagery and point of view, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Araby as evidence for a larger claim about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion in Araby. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Araby as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Araby.

SAT-style questions

1. *Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "derided" most nearly mean?

   A. packages

   B. set free

   C. mocked or ridiculed

   D. a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970

2. *One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died. It was a dark rainy evening and there was no sound in the house. Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds. Some distant lamp or lighted window gleamed below me. I was thankful that I could see so little. All my senses seemed to desire to veil themselves and, feeling that I was about to slip from them, I pressed the palms of my hands together until they trembled, murmuring: "O love! O love!" many times.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Araby"?

   A. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

   B. Courage in defense of home

   C. A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

   D. The futile attempt to shut out death

SAT key: 1. C (mocked or ridiculed); 2. C (A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion)

Unit test

Araby: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 2: “The wild garden behind the house contained a central apple-tree and a few _____ bushes under one of which I found the late tenant's rusty bicycle-pump.” Word bank: drawing, straggling, pulled, Communicant

   Key: straggling

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 4? “The blind was _____ down to within an inch of the sash so that I could not be seen.”

   A. pulled
   B. Communicant
   C. followed
   D. drawing

   Key: A (pulled)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 3? “She was _____ for us, her figure defined by the light from the half-opened door.”

   A. because
   B. doorstep
   C. waiting
   D. returned

   Key: C (waiting)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 9? “She could not go, she said, _____ there would be a retreat that week in her convent.”

   A. tossed
   B. splendid
   C. because
   D. followed

   Key: C (because)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 3? "When we _____ to the street light from the kitchen windows had filled the areas."

   A. summons
   B. returned
   C. waiting
   D. followed

   Key: B (returned)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 9: "She held one of the spikes, bowing her head _____ me." Word bank: tossed, summons, towards, changing

   Key: towards

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 3: "The space of sky above us was the colour of ever-_____ violet and towards it the lamps of the street lifted their feeble lanterns." Word bank: changing, because, splendid, summons

   Key: changing

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 4: "I ran to the hall, seized my books and _____ her." Word bank: returned, followed, Communicant, pulled

   Key: followed

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 2? "Among these I found a few paper-covered books, the pages of which were curled and damp: The Abbot, by Walter Scott, The Devout _____ and The Memoirs of Vidocq."

   A. Communicant
   B. because
   C. pulled
   D. splendid

   Key: A (Communicant)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 3: "Her dress swung as she moved her body and the soft rope of her hair _____ from side to side." Word bank: Communicant, changing, returned, tossed

    Key: tossed

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 4? "I had never spoken to her, except for a few casual words, and yet her name was like a _____ to all my foolish blood."

    A. Communicant
    B. splendid
    C. summons
    D. dinners

    Key: C (summons)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? "If my uncle was seen turning the corner we hid in the shadow until we had seen him safely housed." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 3) accurately and quotes "turning" and "safely", saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 22 reveal about the character or situation? “"Can't you give him the money and let him go?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 22) accurately and quotes its key words, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.
14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 9 reveal about the character or situation? “The light from the lamp opposite our door caught the white curve of her neck, lit up her hair that rested there and, falling, lit up the hand upon the railing.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 9) accurately and quotes “opposite” and “railing”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.
15. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? “Air, musty from having been long enclosed, hung in all the rooms, and the waste room behind the kitchen was littered with old useless papers.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 2) accurately and quotes “enclosed” and “littered”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.
16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 19 shapes its tone: “At nine o'clock I heard my uncle's latchkey in the halldoor.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 19) accurately and quotes “latchkey” and “halldoor”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.
17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 24 shapes its tone: “In front of me was a large building which displayed the magical name.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 24) accurately and quotes “displayed” and “building”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.
18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 13 to the story's treatment of religion and desire: “He was fussing at the hallstand, looking for the hat-brush, and answered me curtly:” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 13) accurately and quotes “hallstand” and “answered”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to religion and desire and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 2: “The former tenant of our house, a priest, had died in the back _____-room.” Word bank: splendid, tossed, drawing, dinners
    Key: drawing
20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “When she addressed the first words to me I was so confused that I did not know what to answer.”

Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 7) accurately and quotes “addressed” and “confused”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “We waited to see whether she would remain or go in and, if she remained, we left our shadow and walked up to Mangan's steps resignedly.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 3) accurately and quotes “resignedly” and “Mangan's”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 23 shapes its tone: “My uncle said he was very sorry he had forgotten.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 23) accurately and quotes “forgotten”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 24 to the story's treatment of romantic idealism and disillusionment: “It crept onward among ruinous houses and over the twinkling river.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 24) accurately and quotes “twinkling” and “ruinous”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to romantic idealism and disillusionment and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “Every morning I lay on the floor in the front parlour watching her door.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 4) accurately and quotes “watching” and “parlour”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “When we met in the street the houses had grown sombre.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 3) accurately and quotes “sombre” and “houses”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of religion and desire: “Her brother and two other boys were fighting for their caps and I was alone at the railings.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 9) accurately and quotes “railings” and “fighting”,

saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to religion and desire and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of romantic idealism and disillusionment: “I forgot whether I answered yes or no.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 7) accurately and quotes “answered” and “whether”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to romantic idealism and disillusionment and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 24 shapes its tone: “I took my seat in a third-class carriage of a deserted train.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 24) accurately and quotes “deserted” and “carriage”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 25 to the story's treatment of romantic idealism and disillusionment: “I found myself in a big hall girdled at half its height by a gallery.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 25) accurately and quotes “gallery” and “girdled”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to romantic idealism and disillusionment and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of romantic idealism and disillusionment: “When she came out on the doorstep my heart leaped.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 4) accurately and quotes “doorstep” and “leaped”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to romantic idealism and disillusionment and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of romantic idealism and disillusionment: his quest collapses.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 25 to the story's treatment of religion and desire: “A few people were gathered about the stalls which were still open.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 25) accurately and quotes “gathered” and “stalls”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to religion and desire and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.11-12.4] In the line “Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.”, what does “impinge” most nearly mean?

    A. mocked or ridiculed

    B. talking too much, especially about unimportant things

    C. to press against or strike upon

    D. came together from different directions

    Key: C (to press against or strike upon)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 2 to the story's treatment of religion and desire: “He had been a very charitable priest; in his will he had left all his money to institutions and the furniture of his house to his sister.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 2) accurately and quotes “institutions” and “charitable”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to religion and desire and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of religion and desire: his quest collapses.

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.11-12.4] In the line “She was an old garrulous woman, a pawnbroker's widow, who collected used stamps for some pious purpose.”, what does “garrulous” most nearly mean?

    A. came together from different directions

    B. talking too much, especially about unimportant things

    C. mocked or ridiculed

    D. to press against or strike upon

    Key: B (talking too much, especially about unimportant things)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 11, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 9, 2, 11, 19, 4, 5, 3, 6, 1, 13, 15, 14, 12, 20, 21, 22, 23	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 5, 9, 10, 1, 8, 3, 7, 19, 12, 14, 13, 15, 24, 25, 17, 26, 27	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 10, 9, 2, 11, 1, 3, 19, 13, 12, 14, 15, 28, 25, 22, 21, 18, 29	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	11, 1, 3, 7, 8, 9, 2, 12, 13, 15, 14, 24, 17, 21, 25, 30, 18, 31	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 11, 7, 32, 13, 12, 15, 22, 17, 21, 20, 16, 24, 33, 23, 29, 18, 31	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman	9, 8, 5, 14, 15, 13, 12, 22, 17, 16, 25, 24, 20, 29, 33, 31, 30, 18	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	2, 3, 19, 15, 13, 12, 17, 21, 24, 16, 20, 22, 26, 30, 23, 31, 29, 33	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	4, 19, 32, 14, 12, 25, 17, 22, 20, 16, 24, 18, 31, 27, 33, 26, 30, 23	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 7
College Senior	3, 19, 32, 12, 28, 21, 16, 25, 17, 22, 29, 18, 26, 23, 31, 33, 30, 27	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 8
Graduate / PhD	34, 19, 32, 28, 24, 17, 22, 25, 16, 21, 31, 26, 30, 23, 27, 33, 18, 29	recall 3, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 8

Final paper

Araby: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how James Joyce develops romantic idealism and disillusionment across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Araby and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to coming of age.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Araby. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Araby finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of religion and desire. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Romantic idealism and disillusionment

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about romantic idealism and disillusionment. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops romantic idealism and disillusionment across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of romantic idealism and disillusionment. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of romantic idealism and disillusionment, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of romantic idealism and disillusionment in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Coming of age

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about coming of age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops coming of age in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops coming of age across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of coming of age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of coming of age in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of coming of age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of coming of age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on coming of age in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on coming of age in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about coming of age in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on coming of age in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Religion and desire

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about religion and desire. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops religion and desire in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops religion and desire across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of religion and desire. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of religion and desire in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of religion and desire, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of religion and desire in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on religion and desire in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on religion and desire in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about religion and desire in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on religion and desire in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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